

WEEKLY MARKET SUMMARY

Week of July 27-31, 2026

Global Markets Analysis · Nomad Capital · July 2026

NASDAQ 100 —
WEEKLY CHANGE**+0.65%**

~28,183 → ~28,365 pts

VIX —
WEEKLY CHANGE**−13.94%**

Close 7/31: 15.99 · vs 18.58 Fri 7/24

WTI CRUDE OIL —
WEEKLY CHANGE**−5.94%**Close 7/31: \$84.77 · Middle East
escalationARGENTINA EMBI —
WEEKLY CHANGE**+4 bps**Close 7/30*: 441 bps · Central Bank
reform

A week dominated by the tension between monetary policy and U.S. data: the Fed held rates at 3.50%–3.75% with the year's sharpest internal split (3 of 12 votes in favor of a hike), while AI-related tech earnings showed extreme dispersion — Microsoft added roughly \$490 billion in market cap in a single session, an all-time record, and Amazon jumped nearly 15% after AWS grew 37% year-over-year, while Meta fell nearly 9% and Apple nearly 8% on weak guidance. In Argentina, Milei announced the reform of the Central Bank's charter in a nationwide address: a single term for the governor, an automatic fiscal rule, and a ban on financing the Treasury. The week's tally: Wall Street closes July with weekly gains, though still below the monthly high set in early July; the Merval tracks the rally, and Argentina's dollar-denominated sovereign curve shows mixed performance.

1. Weekly Timeline

WEEKLY TIMELINE

Mon 7/27	Wall Street opens with strong risk appetite: the Dow adds more than 500 points while oil eases and investors rotate out of semiconductors following the prior week's declines.
Tue 7/28	A cautious session ahead of the Fed meeting: Treasury yields ease slightly while oil retreats and the market positions itself for Wednesday.
Wed 7/29	The Fed holds rates at 3.50%–3.75%, with 3 of 12 votes in favor of a hike — the most visible internal split since Warsh took over. The Dow sheds nearly 800 points intraday before paring losses. The 30-year yield touches its highest level since 2007.
Thu 7/30	A rally led by Microsoft and semiconductors: the Nasdaq snaps a six-session losing streak (+2.8%), the S&P rises 1.7% and the Dow adds 613 points. Microsoft jumps 16% as Azure grows 43% year-over-year. Argentina's EMBI closes at 441 bps (–4 bps).
Fri 7/31	A volatile week closes with gains: Amazon jumps nearly 15% (AWS +37% year-over-year, its best pace in 18 quarters), while Apple falls nearly 8% on weak guidance. The S&P rises 0.7%, the Nasdaq 1%, and the Dow 0.53%. Milei announces the reform of the Central Bank's charter.

2. Weekly and Monthly Asset Price Changes

Prior close: Friday 7/24. Reference close: Friday 7/31.

Asset	Close 7/24	Close 7/31	Wk chg	Mo. chg ²
S&P 500	7,411.98	7,489.80	+1.05%	+0.54%
Nasdaq 100	~28,183	~28,365	+0.65%	–6.61%
Dow Jones	51,947.25	52,485.74	+1.04%	+0.32%
VIX	18.58	15.99	–13.94%	–0.99%
10-Yr UST	4.68%	4.74%	+6 bps	+26 bps
WTI (spot)	\$90.12	\$84.77	–5.94%	+23.41%
Gold (spot)	\$4,055.70	\$4,086.21	+0.75%	–0.64%
Bitcoin	\$65,052.48	\$62,964.22	–3.21%	+7.63%
EMBI Global (Arg.)	437 bps	441 bps*	+4 bps	+26 bps

Argentina local market	Close 7/24	Close 7/31	Wk chg	Mo. chg ²
GD30D	\$0.5827	\$0.5810	–0.29%	–12.09%
GD35D	\$0.8232	\$0.8259	+0.33%	–3.20%
Merval (ARS)	3,283,853.97	3,291,322.63	+0.23%	+2.95%
Merval (USD MEP)	~2,142.88	~2,166.44	+1.10%	+3.31%
USD MEP (AL30)	\$1,532.45	\$1,519.26	–0.79%	–0.37%

* Argentina EMBI: last confirmed official close (Thursday 7/30); JP Morgan publishes the figure with a lag relative to the Buenos Aires session.

² Monthly change uses the close of Tuesday 6/30 (June close) as the base for global assets with a confirmed print (S&P 500, Nasdaq Composite, Dow Jones, Bitcoin); VIX, 10-Yr UST, WTI, Gold, EMBI, and local assets use the close of Thursday 7/2 as a proxy for the June close given proximity of dates.

3. Key Drivers of the Week

KEY DRIVERS

The Fed holds rates amid the year's sharpest internal split

With the range at 3.50%–3.75% and 3 of 12 votes in favor of a hike, the real 10-year yield still sat in the 99th percentile of its annual range despite a second-quarter GDP print below expectations (1.5% vs. 2.0%) and cooler core PCE inflation. Credit markets did not validate that tension — the high-yield spread held at the 48th percentile — suggesting a repricing driven by Fed credibility rather than genuine market stress.

AI earnings show extreme dispersion

Microsoft added roughly \$490 billion in market cap in a single session — an all-time record — after Azure growth accelerated to 43% year-over-year, while Meta fell nearly 9% and Apple nearly 8% on weak guidance. Amazon jumped nearly 15% after AWS grew 37% year-over-year, its best pace in 18 quarters. The market is rewarding whoever monetizes AI spending (Microsoft, Amazon) and punishing whoever merely promises or disappoints on guidance.

Milei announces the reform of the Central Bank's charter

In a nationwide address on Thursday: a single term for the governor, an automatic fiscal rule with penalties, a ban on financing the Treasury, capital markets liberalization, and insurance deregulation. Its durability hinges on surviving a potential change in legislative majority in 2027. The gap between the blue-chip and official dollar touched its high for the year.

Oil holds on to a structural geopolitical premium

The entire curve trades in backwardation, with WTI roughly \$14 above its 12-month contract, underpinned by the Middle East conflict and reduced Saudi exports. The Bank of Japan turned hawkish without moving rates, pushing the yen further toward four-decade lows.

4. Signals to Watch — Week of August 3-7

SIGNALS TO WATCH

Legislative progress on the Central Bank reform

The market will start pricing in the probability of Congressional approval; its durability hinges on surviving a potential change in majority in 2027.

U.S. July jobs report (payrolls)

Released the first Friday of August: the key data point for recalibrating the odds of a September rate hike, currently near 55%.

Evolution of the FX gap and Central Bank intervention

With the gap between the blue-chip and official dollar at its high for the year, the Central Bank's response in the official and MEP markets will be the thermometer for the reform's credibility.

Continuation of AI earnings season

With Microsoft and Amazon confirming the monetization thesis and Meta and Apple disappointing, the market will keep rewarding concrete execution over promises.

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